

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Wahab Riaz

Address: Flats 140 To 148 Westmoreland Drive Sutton SM2 6AJ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: As a resident and stakeholder of Sutton, I formally submit this statement in support of the proposed community hub and place of worship. I believe this application represents an exemplary use of a brownfield site and provides significant public benefit. The site is a former ambulance station, currently vacant and underutilised. Redeveloping this "brownfield" site for community use directly supports National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) goals to prioritise the reuse of previously developed land over greenfield sites.

Also There is a demonstrated local demand for multi-purpose community spaces. This hub will foster social inclusion, provide health and wellbeing benefits, and serve as a vital local asset for a range of demographics, including families and the elderly.

Contrary to concerns about new traffic, this facility is designed to serve the existing local population. By providing a hub within walking and cycling distance for nearby residents and school-run parents, the project reduces the need for private vehicle trips, directly supporting Sutton's sustainability and "Healthy Streets" targets. Nevertheless any traffic would be after peak hours not affecting the neighbourhood.

Looking at the proposed design it shows respect of the residential character of the area. Its scale and architectural approach are proportionate to the surrounding streetscape, ensuring that the development integrates respectfully without harming local amenity.

This project represents a significant private investment into community infrastructure. It provides a "place of worship" (Class F1) and a community hub without requiring public funding, while still contributing to the borough's social fabric.

So This proposal transforms a redundant site into a vibrant community anchor. I respectfully urge the Planning Committee to approve application DM2025/01591, as it is demonstrably in

accordance with both local and national planning policy.